

Ziquan Wei

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EDUCATION

- University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, USA *PhD in Computer Science, Aug 2023 - May 2028*
- Huazhong University of Science and Technology, China *Master in Biomedical Engineering, Sept 2019 - June 2022*
- Yunnan Normal University, China *Bachelor in Computer Science, Sept 2015 - June 2019*

RESEARCH INTEREST

AI for healthcare: personalized, individual-level models that turn routinely collected clinical data (EHR event sequences, imaging, ECG) into individual-level disease predictions. I also work on cross-site robustness, label scarcity, and local inference.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill [\[🌐\]](#) *Research Assistant, Aug 2023 - Current*
 - **Personalized Digital Twins:** Built an SDoH-conditioned latent diffusion model linking tokenized EHR event sequences to multi-organ MRI on UK Biobank (~500K histories; 44.8K brain / 24.0K heart / 28.7K liver / 32.2K kidney imaged participants), evaluated on 1,000+ diseases, with scenario generation by conditioning on an altered mediating state [3]; and a mechanics foundation model for individualized 4D cardiac motion generation conditioned on the surface ECG [5]. Co-authored an ICLR '25 Spotlight on conditional diffusion with ordinal regression for longitudinal disease-progression generation [16].
 - **Brain Foundation Models:** Pretrained the Large Connectome Model (1.2B) with a multitask brain-environment interaction objective, and BrainMoE, a Mixture-of-Experts with a cognition joint embedding for robustness across cohorts and pipelines, on UK Biobank / HCP / ADNI / OASIS / ABIDE / PPMI for case-control classification of autism, Parkinson's, and Alzheimer's; added BECA meta-matching for zero-shot transfer where labels are scarce [1][14][13].
 - **Cross-Site Robustness:** Contributed to a Wasserstein-distance recipe for replicable deep models across sites, scanners, and pipelines [7][21], and co-authored a review of its pitfalls and interpretation limits [9].
- EGRA.ai [\[🌐\]](#) *Research Intern, May 2026 - Aug 2026*
 - **RL post-training:** Trained a reward model on physiological feedback signals to supplement human preference labels, and ran GRPO policy optimization against a programmatically verifiable composite reward.
- University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill *Predoctoral Fellow, Aug 2022 - Aug 2023*
 - **Teravoxel Microscopy at Cohort Scale:** Built 3D nucleus instance segmentation and the CellPheno phenotyping platform for whole-brain lightsheet images, applied across a 118-brain cohort [24][6].
- Huazhong University of Science and Technology *Graduate Researcher (MSc), Sept 2019 - June 2022*
 - **Cancer Screening at Scale:** First-authored a cervical cytology framework that processes a 4-gigapixel slide in 55.9s [27], and a glandular-cell detector for whole slide images with out-of-distribution data [26]; contributed to the multi-center cervical cancer screening system in Nature Communications (3,545 slides, 5 hospitals, 5 scanner types; 95.1% sensitivity / 93.5% specificity on 1,170 independent patient-level slides) [29].

PROJECTS

- **CyberNeuro: On-Device Multi-Agent Assistant for Neuroimaging and Biomarker Data** *Jan 2026 - May 2026*
Tools: [Ollama, MedGemma, gpt-oss, FastMCP, A2A, LangGraph, FastAPI, React] [\[🔗, Kaggle Writeup, Demo\]](#)
 - **Led the project** (47 of 84 commits, 6-person team) for the Kaggle MedGemma Impact Challenge: users chat with their own laboratory results, imaging-derived phenotypes, and MRI while every inference runs locally via Ollama (MedGemma 4B, gpt-oss 20B), so user data never leaves the machine.
 - **Built an 11-role agent system** (planner → critic → executor → researcher → reporter) over an MCP tool layer that grounds answers in retrieved PubMed / OpenAlex evidence and normative reference curves, with reflection under a retry budget and state rollback; on an in-house 500-query benchmark it reaches 93.6% end-to-end task success and 95.8% routing accuracy (100% precision, 88.7% recall) at 19.33s per query.

SKILLS

- **Personalized & Clinical AI:** Conditional diffusion & digital twins, longitudinal disease-progression modeling, foundation-model pretraining (1.2B), Mixture-of-Experts, zero-shot meta-matching, multi-site external validation, case-control diagnostic classification, RLHF & GRPO, LLM agents with MCP tool use
- **Health Data:** UK Biobank, HCP, ADNI, OASIS, ABIDE, PPMI; EHR / ICD event sequences, social determinants of health; fMRI, DWI, PET, T1, ECG, pathology WSI, teravoxel LFSM; BIDS, DICOM, NIfTI, local inference
- **Engineering:** Python, PyTorch, C++, TypeScript / React, FastAPI, MedGemma / gpt-oss, Ollama, FastMCP, Nextflow, multi-GPU distributed training, HPC administration (10 nodes, 20 GPUs, 1.5PB)

- [1] Wei Z., Dan T., Wu G. **Large Connectome Model: An fMRI Foundation Model of Brain Connectomes Empowered by Brain-Environment Interaction in Multitask Learning Landscape.** *AAAI* '26.
- [2] Wei Z., Wu G. **Teravoxel Microscopy Image Analysis for Neurological Diseases.** *ARBME* '26 (IF=11.5).
- [3] Wei Z., Dan T., Wu G. **Marrying Generative Model of Healthcare Events with Digital Twin of Social Determinants of Health for Disease Reasoning.** *ICML* '26.
- [4] Wei Z., Dan T., Ding J., Laurienti P.J., Wu G. **NeuroDetour: A Neural Pathway Transformer for Uncovering Structural-Functional Coupling Mechanisms in Human Connectome.** *MedIA* '26 (IF=14.0).
- [5] Wei Z., et al. **From Heartbeat to Cardiochoreography: A Mechanics Foundation Model for Individualized 4D Cardiac Motion Generation Conditioned on Electrophysiology.** *NeurIPS* '26 (In submission, ratings 5 4 4).
- [6] Wei Z., Curtin I., Kyere F.A., et al. **CellPheno: A High-throughput Computational Platform for Quantifying Cellular Resolution Whole Brain Microscopy Images.** *bioRxiv* '26.
- [7] Ding J., Dan T., Wei Z., Laurienti P.J., Wu G. **Scanning the Horizon of Replicability in Neuroscience: A Recipe of Developing Replicable Deep Models for Functional Neuroimages.** *IEEE TBME* '26 (IF=4.5).
- [8] Wen T., Wei Z., Dan T., et al. **Image Imputation for Real-World Defective Microscopy Images of Mouse Brains.** *ISBI* '26.
- [9] Ding J., Dan T., Wei Z., Laurienti P.J., Wu G. **Machine learning on dynamic functional connectivity: Promise, pitfalls, and interpretations.** *Inf. Sci.* '26 (IF=6.0).
- [10] Chen Y., Li Y., Tong J., ..., Wei Z., et al. **NeuroPilot: An Agent-Driven Smart Pipeline for Processing, Quality Control, and Managing Neuroimages.** *arXiv* '26.
- [11] Kyere F.†, Curtin I.†, Wei Z.†, et al. **Chd8 haploinsufficiency leads to molecular layer heterotopias and age-dependent cortical expansion.** *bioRxiv* '26.
- [12] Wei Z., Dan T., Ding J., Wu G. **Efficient Graph Representation Learning by Non-Local Information Exchange.** *Electronics* '25 (IF=2.9).
- [13] Wei Z., Dan T., Wu G. **Brain-Environment Cross-Attention (BECA) Meta-matching: A New Perspective of Brain Connectome Zero-Shot Learning.** *MICCAI* '25 (Early accept (9%)).
- [14] Wei Z., Dan T., Chen T., Wu G. **BrainMoE: Cognition Joint Embedding via Mixture-of-Expert Towards Robust Brain Foundation Model.** *NeurIPS* '25.
- [15] Cho H., Wei Z., Lee S., et al. **Conditional Diffusion Model using Ordinal Regression for Longitudinal Neurodegenerative Data Generation.** *Alz. & Dem.* '25 (IF=12.8).
- [16] Cho H., Wei Z., Lee S., et al. **Conditional Diffusion with Ordinal Regression: Longitudinal Data Generation for Neurodegenerative Disease Studies.** *ICLR* '25 (Spotlight poster (3.26%)).
- [17] Wei Z., Dan T., Ding J., Laurienti P., Wu G. **Representing Functional Connectivity with Structural Detour: A New Perspective to Decipher Structure-Function Coupling Mechanism.** *MICCAI* '24.
- [18] Wei Z., Dan T., Ding J., Wu G. **NeuroPath: A Neural Pathway Transformer for Joining the Dots of Human Connectomes.** *NeurIPS* '24.
- [19] Wei Z., Wu G. **Non-local Exchange: Introduce Non-locality via Graph Re-wiring to Graph Neural Networks.** *NeurIPS-W* '24.
- [20] Dan T., Wei Z., Kim W.H., Wu G. **Exploring the Enigma of Neural Dynamics Through A Scattering-Transform Mixer Landscape for Riemannian Manifold.** *ICML* '24.
- [21] Ding J., Dan T., Wei Z., Laurienti P., Wu G. **A Wasserstein Recipe for Replicable Machine Learning on Functional Neuroimages.** *MICCAI* '24.
- [22] Wu Y., Liu Y., Li Y., ..., Wei Z., et al. **Symmetry engineering in 2D bioelectronics facilitating augmented biosensing interfaces.** *PNAS* '24 (IF=9.5).
- [23] Wei Z., Dan T., Ding J., et al. **High Throughput Deep Model of 3D Nucleus Instance Segmentation by Stereo Stitching Contextual Gaps.** *ISBI* '23.
- [24] Wei Z., Dan T., Ding J., Dere M., Wu G. **A General Stitching Solution for Whole-Brain 3D Nuclei Instance Segmentation from Microscopy Images.** *MICCAI* '23 (Early accept (14%)).
- [25] Dan T., Ding J., Wei Z., et al. **Re-think and re-design graph neural networks in spaces of continuous graph diffusion functionals.** *NeurIPS* '23.
- [26] Wei Z., Cheng S., Cai J., et al. **Cervical Glandular Cell Detection from Whole Slide Image with Out-Of-Distribution Data.** *arXiv* '22.
- [27] Wei Z., Cheng S., Hu J., et al. **An Efficient Cervical Whole Slide Image Analysis Framework Based on Multi-scale Semantic and Location Deep Features.** *arXiv* '21.
- [28] Zhang S.†, Ding Y.†, Wei Z.†, Guan C. **Continuous emotion recognition with audio-visual leader-follower attentive fusion.** *ICCVW* '21.
- [29] Cheng S., Liu S., Yu J., ..., Wei Z., et al. **Robust whole slide image analysis for cervical cancer screening using deep learning.** *Nat. Comm.* '21 (IF=18.1).
- [30] Yang Z., Yang Y., Yang K., Wei Z.. **Non-rigid image registration with dynamic Gaussian component density and space curvature preservation.** *IEEE TIP* '18 (IF=13.7).
- [31] Zhang S., Yang K., Yang Y., Luo Y., Wei Z.. **Non-rigid point set registration using dual-feature finite mixture model and global-local structural preservation.** *Pattern Recognit.* '18 (IF=9.1).
- [32] Wei Z., Han Y., Li M., et al. **A small UAV based multi-temporal image registration for dynamic agricultural terrace monitoring.** *Remote Sens.* '17 (IF=4.3).

HONORS & SERVICE

- **Honors:** Editor of Distinction Award 2025, Scientific Reports (editorial board); Graduate School Transportation Grant, UNC-Chapel Hill; Outstanding Graduate, Huazhong University of Science and Technology
- **Conference Reviewer:** NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR, AAAI, AISTATS, MICCAI
- **Journal Reviewer:** IEEE Transactions on Medical Imaging, NeuroImage, Pattern Recognition

TALKS

- 2025 Tissue Clearing & Imaging Conference, UNC-Chapel Hill  Speaker, Apr 2025
- **CellPheno:** A High-throughput Computational Platform of Cellular Phenotyping for Real-world Whole Brain Microscopy Images.